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Ruling the goal-scoring charts

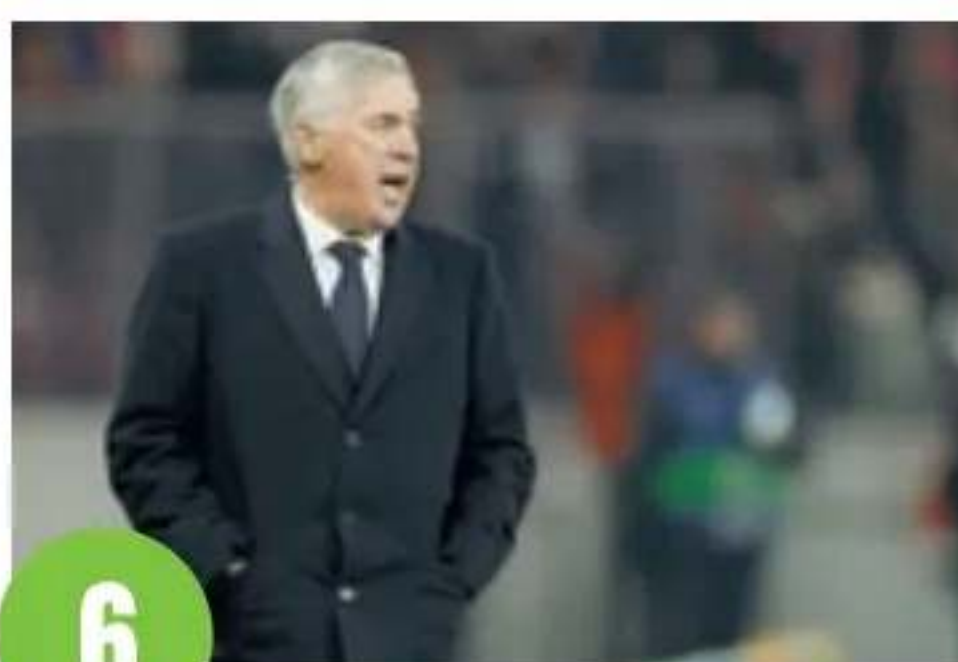
Al Nassr's Cristiano Ronaldo cemented his position as the top goal-scorer in 2023 after his goal against Al Taawoun in the Saudi Pro League. Ronaldo finished with 54 goals in the calendar year, finishing ahead of Kylian Mbappe, Erling Haaland and Harry Kane.



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A new dawn for Man United?

British billionaire Sir Jim Ratcliffe struck a long-awaited deal to buy a 25 per cent stake in Manchester United with reports suggesting an incoming investment of \$300 million in the club. Ratcliffe's INEOS group is set to take over management of the club's football operations, more than a year after the Glazer family announced its willingness to put the club up for sale.



AFP

Two more seasons at Madrid for Don Carlo

Spanish giants Real Madrid extended the contract of Italian manager Carlo Ancelotti until 2026, quashing the rumours of him taking up the top job at the Brazil national team at the end of the season. Ancelotti has won 10 titles with Madrid, including two Champions Leagues and one Spanish league.



AFP

Tinge of nostalgia

Lionel Messi will face his former club Newell's Old Boys in February 2024 after Inter Miami announced a preseason friendly fixture at the DRV PNK Stadium in Miami. Messi and manager Gerardo Martino both hail from the town of Rosario out of which the club is based. While Messi left after a productive youth career, Martino aggregated the most appearances of any player in the club's history.

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